

Pressure & Stress

Character **First****GOALS MONTH 2**

- You recognize the physical and mental signals of stress in yourself
- You master at least one breathing technique to regulate activation
- You can name the difference between problem-focused and emotion-focused coping

Feeling pressure is normal. Every top athlete feels it. What makes the difference is how you deal with it. This worksheet helps you discover how your body and mind respond to stress.

EXERCISE 1 — BOX BREATHING LOG**1 Box Breathing Log**

Practice Box Breathing at least 3× this month before training or a match. Note each time: date, situation and how you felt before and after (scale 1–10).

DATUM & SITUATIE

BEFORE (1–10)

AFTER (1–10)

What do I notice after Box Breathing in myself?

EXERCISE 2 — STRESS DIARY**2 Stress Diary**

Write three things after your next match: what did you feel, what did you think, and what did you do?

What did I feel? (physical and emotional)

What did I think?

What did I do? (how did I respond to the pressure?)

EXERCISE 3 — WORST CASE · BEST CASE · MOST LIKELY

3 Worst Case Best Case

Think of an upcoming situation that makes you nervous. Write the three scenarios in detail. What is really the worst that can happen? What if it all goes well?

WORST CASE**BEST CASE****MOST LIKELY**

What will I do when the pressure builds? My plan:

"Pressure is a privilege — it only comes to those who earn it."

Billie Jean King — 39× Grand Slam Champion